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FOLIO · SI-003-DECISION

Decision Sovereignty

Who sets the timeline and criteria? A framework for reclaiming control over your most critical choices.

CONTROL METADATA

REFERENCE	SI-003-DECISION
ISSUE DATE	21 March 2026
VERSION	1.0.0
TRANSMISSION ID	8573-9819-16B7
CIRCULATION	Controlled distribution within portfolio

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CLASSIFICATION

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KEY JUDGEMENTS

- 01. What triggered the decision timeline?
- 02. Whose criteria were used to evaluate options?
- 03. Could you have said no?
- 04. **Timeline**: 0 = dictated, 1 = reactive, 2 = proactive, 3 = sovereign
- 05. **Criteria**: 0 = external imposed, 1 = external adopted, 2 = internal, 3 = generational

BODY OF BRIEF

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I. Executive Summary

Decision sovereignty is the capacity to make choices based on your own principles, timeline, and assessment of reality—rather than being forced into decisions by external pressures. It is the second layer of the Strata Framework, and for many institutions, it is the most urgent to address.

Average Decision Windows by Sector:

8573-9819-16B7 · SIG AOL-9C739F7ADCB E940A

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IV. The Decision Criteria Audit

Step 1: Document your last five major decisions

For each decision, identify: - What triggered the decision timeline? - Whose criteria were used to evaluate options? - Could you have said no?

Step 2: Classify criteria sources

Decision	Trigger Source	Criteria Source	Veto Exercised?
[Decision 1]		[Decision 2]	
[Decision 3]		[Decision 4]	
[Decision 5]			

Step 3: Calculate your sovereignty score

For each decision, score 0–3: - ****Timeline****: 0 = dictated, 1 = reactive, 2 = proactive, 3 = sovereign - ****Criteria****: 0 = external imposed, 1 = external adopted, 2 = internal, 3 = generational - ****Veto****: 0 = none, 1 = conditional, 2 = absolute
****Average score < 1.5****: Decision sovereignty requires immediate attention.

V. The Sovereignty-Building Sequence

Phase 1: Extend the Window (0–6 months)

- ☐ Calculate your current decision window - ☐ Identify the single factor most constraining it - ☐ Extend cash runway by 30 days - ☐ Create redundancy in critical relationships - ☐ Reduce dependency on any single external party

Phase 2: Codify Criteria (6–12 months)

- ☐ Document decision criteria for major categories - ☐ Develop proprietary frameworks - ☐ Train leadership team in criteria application - ☐ Review past decisions against criteria - ☐ Refine based on outcomes

Phase 3: Institutionalize Veto (12–24 months)

- ☐ Identify where "no" is currently impossible - ☐ Build alternatives for those dependencies - ☐ Create structural veto capacity - ☐ Test veto in low-stakes situations - ☐ Embed in governance documents

VI. Case Study: The 14-Day Window

****Institution****: Mid-sized manufacturer

****Situation****: A key supplier was acquired by a competitor and gave 90 days' notice of contract termination. The leadership had 14 days to decide whether to sign a new deal at 40% higher prices or pivot to an untested alternative.

****Autopsy****: - Decision window before crisis: 45 days - Actual window under pressure: 14 days - Criteria: None documented - Veto: Impossible (single supplier)

****Outcome****: Signed unfavorable deal, margins compressed for 3 years, CEO replaced.

****Post-mortem sovereignty build****: - New window: 18 months - Criteria: Documented - Veto: Multiple supplier relationships

VII. The Sovereign Decision Protocol

For Strategic Decisions (Annual, Major)

1. ****Freeze****: No decision for 30 days (test your window) 2. ****Frame****: Apply proprietary criteria only 3. ****Field****: Gather primary intelligence 4. ****Filter****: Test against generational perspective 5. ****Finalize****: Document rationale for posterity

For Tactical Decisions (Quarterly)

1. ****Pause****: 72-hour minimum 2. ****Principles****: Check against documented criteria 3. ****Proceed****: Execute with clear rationale

For Operational Decisions (Daily)

1. ****Systematize****: Pre-decide via protocols 2. ****Execute****: Trust the system 3. ****Review****: Quarterly audit

****Institutional Principle****: The quality of your decisions is determined not by your intelligence in the moment, but by the quality of your criteria before the moment arrives. ---

VIII. Conclusion Decision sovereignty is built, not discovered. It requires: - Extending your timeline beyond anyone else's urgency - Developing criteria that reflect your principles, not your pressures - Creating veto capacity that makes partnership optional The institution that masters these three dimensions can wait longer, choose better, and say no more often than its competitors. That is the sovereign advantage. --- Before implementing decision protocols, ensure your Infrastructure Sovereignty is baseline secure. Decisions cannot be sovereign if the rails they run on are not yours.

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Issued under the authority of The Architect. Reference: SI-003-DECISION. Trace: 8573-9819-16B7.

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